

Lab - Deployment Slots - Performing the Swap

To Begin with the Lab

Summary

This lab demonstrates how to use **Azure App Service Deployment Slots** to safely deploy a new version of a web application. By performing a **slot swap**, the application running in the staging slot becomes the production version with minimal downtime, while the previous production version is moved to the staging slot.

Understanding

Azure Deployment Slots allow you to deploy and test new versions of your application before making them available to users. A deployment slot has its own hostname and configuration, enabling you to validate the application in a production-like environment. When you perform a **swap**, Azure exchanges the content and selected configuration between the source slot (for example, **Staging**) and the target slot (typically **Production**). This process helps achieve near-zero downtime deployments and provides a quick rollback option if any issues are discovered after deployment.

Example:

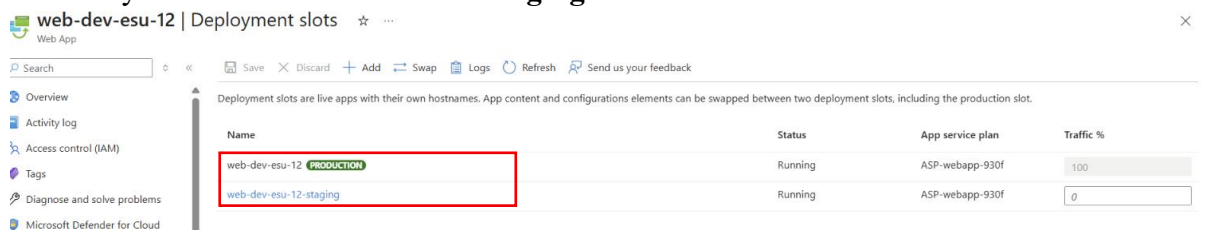
Suppose your production slot is running **Version 1** of your application, and the staging slot contains **Version 2**. After testing Version 2 in the staging slot, you perform a slot swap. Version 2 immediately becomes the production application, while Version 1 moves to the staging slot. If a problem is found, you can swap again to restore Version 1.

Step 1: Open the Azure App Service

- Sign in to the Azure portal.
- Search for **App Services**.
- Open your deployed web application.

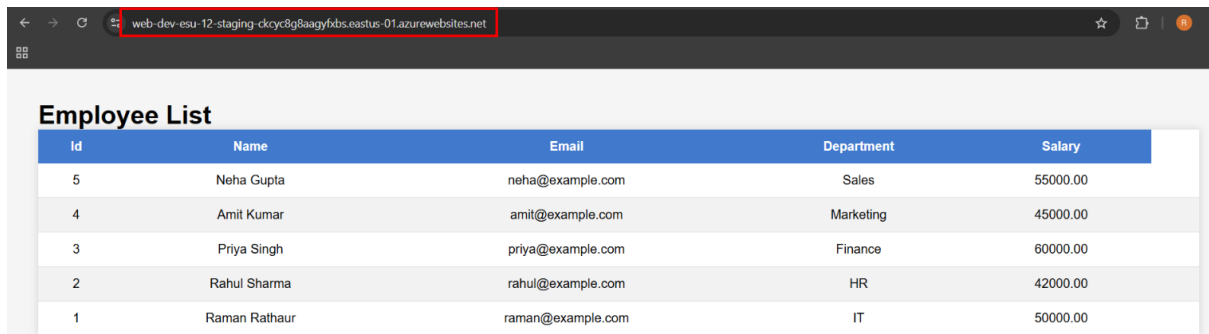
Step 2: Open Deployment Slots

- In the left navigation pane, select **Deployment slots**.
- Verify that both **Production** and **Staging** slots are available.



Step 3: Verify the Staging Slot

- Open the **Staging** slot.
- Browse the staging URL.
- Confirm that the updated application is working correctly.



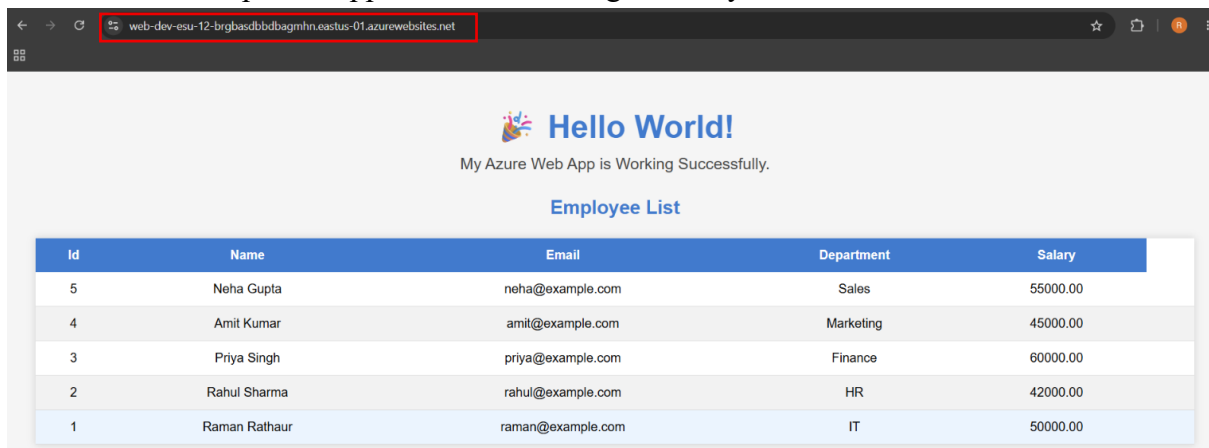
Employee List

Id	Name	Email	Department	Salary
5	Neha Gupta	neha@example.com	Sales	55000.00
4	Amit Kumar	amit@example.com	Marketing	45000.00
3	Priya Singh	priya@example.com	Finance	60000.00
2	Rahul Sharma	rahul@example.com	HR	42000.00
1	Raman Rathaur	raman@example.com	IT	50000.00

Step 4: Verify the Production Application

- Open the **Staging** slot.
- Browse the staging URL.

Confirm that the updated application is working correctly



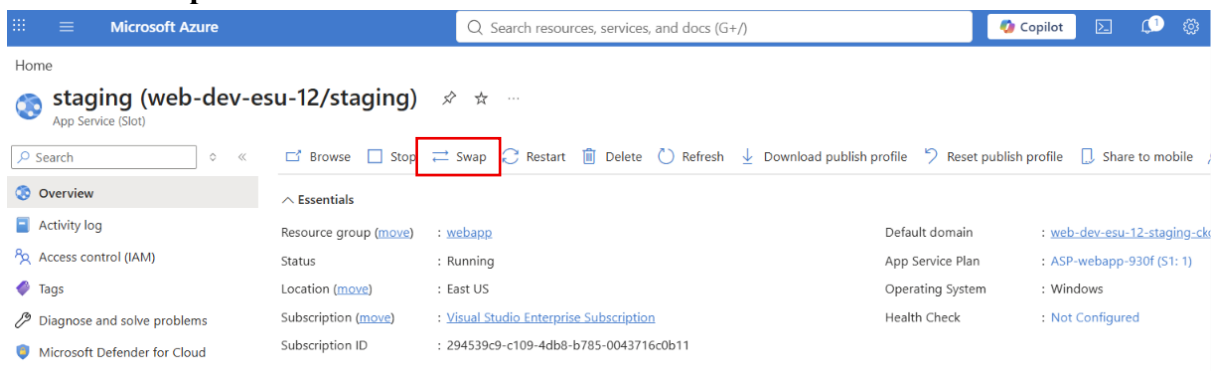
Hello World!
My Azure Web App is Working Successfully.

Employee List

Id	Name	Email	Department	Salary
5	Neha Gupta	neha@example.com	Sales	55000.00
4	Amit Kumar	amit@example.com	Marketing	45000.00
3	Priya Singh	priya@example.com	Finance	60000.00
2	Rahul Sharma	rahul@example.com	HR	42000.00
1	Raman Rathaur	raman@example.com	IT	50000.00

Step 5: Start the Swap

- Return to the **Deployment slots** page.
- Click **Swap** from the toolbar.



Microsoft Azure

Search resources, services, and docs (G+/)

Home

staging (web-dev-esu-12/staging) App Service (Slot)

Search

Browse Stop **Swap** Restart Delete Refresh Download publish profile Reset publish profile Share to mobile

Overview

Activity log

Access control (IAM)

Tags

Diagnose and solve problems

Microsoft Defender for Cloud

Essentials

Resource group (move) : [webapp](#)

Status : Running

Location (move) : East US

Subscription (move) : [Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription](#)

Subscription ID : 294539c9-c109-4db8-b785-0043716c0b11

Default domain : [web-dev-esu-12-staging-ck...](#)

App Service Plan : [ASP-webapp-930f \(S1: 1\)](#)

Operating System : Windows

Health Check : Not Configured

- Select:
 - **Source Slot:** Staging
 - **Target Slot:** Production
- Click on the **Start swap**

i-12/staging) ☆ ☆ ...

Browse
Stop
Swap
Restart
Delete
Refresh
Download publish profile

^ Essentials

Resource group (move) : webapp
Status : Running
Location (move) : East US
Subscription (move) : Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription
Subscription ID : 294539c9-c109-4db8-b785-0043716c0b11
Tags (edit) : Add tags

Properties
Monitoring
Logs
Capabilities
Notifications (0)
Recommendations

Web app

Name : web-dev-esu-12/staging
Publishing model : Code
Runtime Stack : Dotnet - v10.0

Domains

Default domain : web-dev-esu-12-staging-ckcyc8g8aagyfxbs.eastus-01.azurewebsites.net
Custom domain : Add custom domain

Hosting

Plan : Free
App Service plan : App Service plan

Default deployment slot
App Service
Operating system
Health check

Swap

Source : web-dev-esu-12-staging
Target : PRODUCTION web-dev-esu-12

☐ Perform swap with preview

Config Changes
This is a summary of the final set of configuration changes on the source and target deployment slots after the swap has completed.

Source slot changes
Target slot changes

Setting	Type	Old Value	New Value
No Changes			

Start Swap
Close

Step 6: Review Swap Settings

- Review the source and destination slots.
- Verify that the selected slot configuration is correct.
- Click **Start Swap** or **Swap**.

i-12/staging) ☆ ☆ ...

Browse
Stop
Swap
Restart
Delete
Refresh
Download publish profile

^ Essentials

Resource group (move) : webapp
Status : Running
Location (move) : East US
Subscription (move) : Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription
Subscription ID : 294539c9-c109-4db8-b785-0043716c0b11
Tags (edit) : Add tags

Properties
Monitoring
Logs
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Web app

Name : web-dev-esu-12/staging
Publishing model : Code
Runtime Stack : Dotnet - v10.0

Domains

Default domain : web-dev-esu-12-staging-ckcyc8g8aagyfxbs.eastus-01.azurewebsites.net
Custom domain : Add custom domain

Hosting

Plan : Free
App Service plan : App Service plan

Default deployment slot
App Service
Operating system
Health check

Swap

Source : web-dev-esu-12-staging
Target : PRODUCTION web-dev-esu-12

☐ Perform swap with preview

Config Changes
This is a summary of the final set of configuration changes on the source and target deployment slots after the swap has completed.

Source slot changes
Target slot changes

Setting	Type	Old Value	New Value
No Changes			

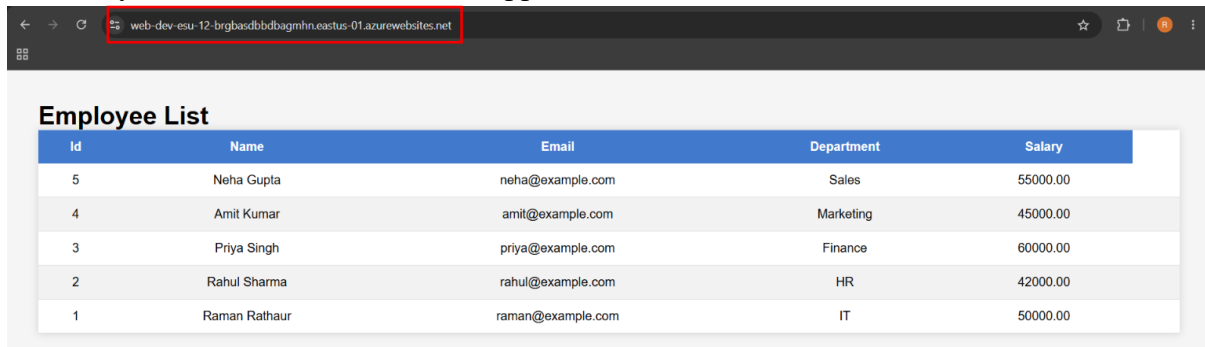
Start Swap
Close

Step 7: Wait for the Swap to Complete

- Azure validates the application.
- Configuration settings are applied.
- The deployment slots are swapped.
- Wait until the operation completes successfully.

Step 8: Verify the Production Application

- Open the production URL.
- Refresh the page.
- Verify that the new version of the application is now live.

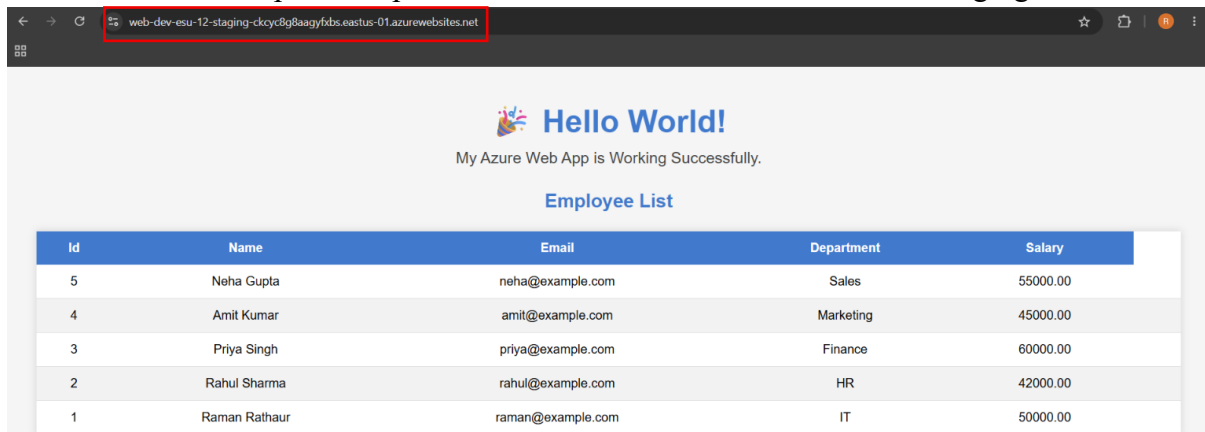


The screenshot shows a web browser with the URL `web-dev-esu-12-brgbasdbdbagmhn.eastus-01.azurewebsites.net` highlighted in the address bar. The page displays an "Employee List" table with the following data:

Id	Name	Email	Department	Salary
5	Neha Gupta	neha@example.com	Sales	55000.00
4	Amit Kumar	amit@example.com	Marketing	45000.00
3	Priya Singh	priya@example.com	Finance	60000.00
2	Rahul Sharma	rahul@example.com	HR	42000.00
1	Raman Rathaur	raman@example.com	IT	50000.00

Step 9: Verify the Staging Slot

- Open the staging slot URL.
- Confirm that the previous production version is now available in the staging slot.

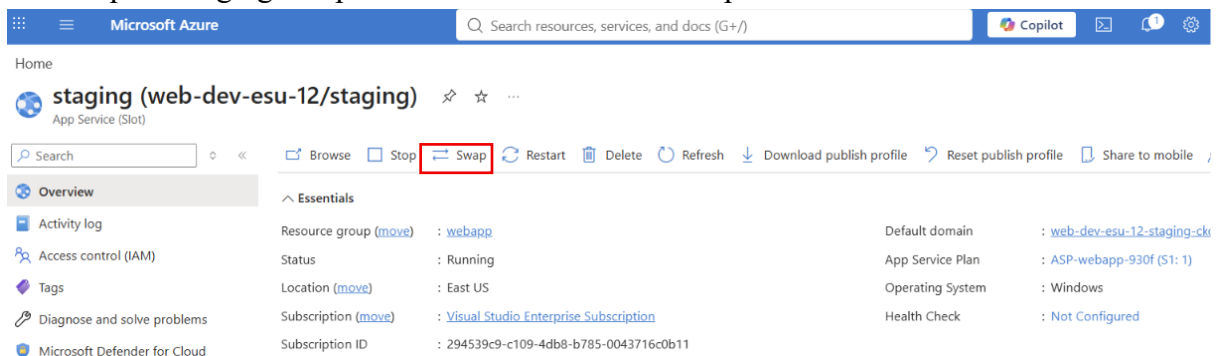


The screenshot shows a web browser with the URL `web-dev-esu-12-staging-ckyc8g8aagyfbs.eastus-01.azurewebsites.net` highlighted in the address bar. The page displays a "Hello World!" message and a message stating "My Azure Web App is Working Successfully." Below this, there is an "Employee List" table with the same data as in Step 8:

Id	Name	Email	Department	Salary
5	Neha Gupta	neha@example.com	Sales	55000.00
4	Amit Kumar	amit@example.com	Marketing	45000.00
3	Priya Singh	priya@example.com	Finance	60000.00
2	Rahul Sharma	rahul@example.com	HR	42000.00
1	Raman Rathaur	raman@example.com	IT	50000.00

Step 10: Roll Back (Optional)

- If any issues are detected in production, open **Deployment slots**.
- Click **Swap** again.
- Swap the staging and production slots to restore the previous version.



The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure portal interface. The top navigation bar includes the "Microsoft Azure" logo, a search bar, and the "Copilot" button. The main content area shows the "staging (web-dev-esu-12/staging)" App Service (Slot). The "Overview" tab is selected, displaying the following details:

- Resource group (move): `webapp`
- Status: `Running`
- Location (move): `East US`
- Subscription (move): `Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription`
- Subscription ID: `294539c9-c109-4db8-b785-0043716c0b11`
- Default domain: `web-dev-esu-12-staging-ck`
- App Service Plan: `ASP-webapp-930f (S1: 1)`
- Operating System: `Windows`
- Health Check: `Not Configured`

Step 11: Verify Successful Deployment

- Ensure the production application is functioning correctly.
- Confirm that the staging slot contains the previous version.
- Review deployment status in the Azure portal.

Employee List

Id	Name	Email	Department	Salary
5	Neha Gupta	neha@example.com	Sales	55000.00
4	Amit Kumar	amit@example.com	Marketing	45000.00
3	Priya Singh	priya@example.com	Finance	60000.00
2	Rahul Sharma	rahul@example.com	HR	42000.00
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